CONFIDENTIAL — MARCH 2026

Engineering *Excellence* Assessment

A 15-30 day deep tech intervention for startups and enterprises

Nikhil Vallishayee • GruWorks

THE PROBLEM

Tech Is a Black Box

Your dev team ships. Revenue grows. But you can't tell good from dangerous.

WHAT FOUNDERS HEAR

"Everything is on track"	→	No way to verify
"We need to hire more"	→	Is that true? Or is it process?
"The code is fine"	→	40% test coverage says otherwise
"We should rewrite"	→	Based on what evidence?

WHAT YOU NEED

Independent. Not from your team, not from a vendor.

Structured. Same dimensions every time. Comparable.

Evidence-based. Data, not opinions.

Actionable. A clear picture. A clear path forward.

> *You're about to raise, scale, or pivot. You need to know: is the foundation solid?*

THE FRAMEWORK

5 Dimensions of Excellence

Every dimension scored independently. Evidence-backed. Comparable across time.

CODE QUALITY	SYSTEM QUALITY	TEAM HEALTH	WORKFLOW MATURITY	GROWTH READINESS
Complexity, duplication, coverage, dependencies, security	Architecture, performance, reliability, scalability, observability	Velocity, bus factor, ownership, review quality, skills	CI/CD, DORA metrics, branching, release, incidents	10x load, hiring, tech debt trajectory, compliance

> *Same framework. Every time. Comparable across teams, quarters, and companies.*

TYPICAL FINDINGS

What We Usually Discover

Based on assessments of 15-30 person engineering teams at Indian startups.

FINDING	FREQUENCY	IMPACT
Test coverage below 40%	80%	Regressions, fear of refactoring
No CODEOWNERS or knowledge mapping	90%	Bus factor of 1 for critical modules
CI pipeline takes 20+ minutes	70%	Dev velocity drops 30-40%
No structured incident response	85%	MTTR 3-5x longer than necessary
Senior devs doing junior work	75%	Salary inefficiency + burnout
Tech debt growing faster than features	60%	6-12 month scaling wall
Security basics missing (OWASP Top 5)	70%	One breach = existential risk
No observability beyond basic logging	80%	Debugging in production = guesswork

THE PROCESS

5 Phases. 30 Days.

Discovery 1
DAYS 1-3

- Founder + CTO kick-off
- Access setup (Git, CI, APM)
- 1:1 with each EM
- Scope confirmation

Automated 2
DAYS 3-8

- Git commit intelligence
- Static code analysis
- Dependency + CVE audit
- CI/CD pipeline audit

Human Intel 3
DAYS 8-18

- Code walkthroughs
- 1:1 dev interviews
- Sprint observation
- Architecture review

Synthesis 4
DAYS 18-25

- 5 dimension scorecards
- Risk register
- Improvement roadmap
- Executive report

Handover 5
DAYS 25-30

- Founder presentation
- Team presentation
- EM working session
- 30-day check-in

> *Automated tools find the data. Human intelligence finds the meaning.*

THE OUTCOME

From Black Box to Clear Picture

"Tech is a black box"	→	5-dimension scorecard with evidence
"I think we're okay"	→	Risk register: RED / AMBER / GREEN
"We need to hire more"	→	Specific skill gaps + hiring plan
"Should we rewrite?"	→	Quantified tech debt + trajectory
"Are we secure?"	→	OWASP audit + remediation plan
"Can we scale?"	→	Load test results + architecture review

DELIVERABLES

FOR FOUNDERS

Executive Summary

2-page overview. What's working. What's at risk. What to do first. No jargon.

FOR CTO & EMS

Full Assessment Report

30-50 pages. Scorecards, risk register, improvement roadmap, raw data package.

FOR DEV TEAM

Quick Wins Checklist

Improvements implementable in 7 days. Immediate velocity and quality gains.

WHO WE ARE

Why This Team

NIKHIL VALLISHAYEE — FOUNDER

- **ThoughtWorks** — XP, continuous delivery, agile coaching at enterprise scale
- **Swiggy aSDE Program** — Assessed, trained, promoted 150+ engineers from Tier II/III cities
- **Vedantu, Navi** — Deep tech product across India's top startups
- **15+ years** building and evaluating engineering teams at scale
- **DPIIT-recognized** AI startup with working assessment infrastructure

AI-NATIVE TOOLING

Git Intelligence Engine

Automated commit pattern analysis, contributor heatmaps, workflow bottleneck detection, PR quality scoring

Multi-Agent Assessment

Concurrent analysis across repos, CI/CD pipelines, project management tools — 10x faster than manual review

Structured Scoring Framework

Same dimensions, same metrics, comparable across teams, quarters, and companies. Data-driven, not opinion-driven.

INVESTMENT

Startup or Enterprise

STARTUP

Rs. 10L

15-30 days • up to 20 people

- ✓ Full 5-dimension assessment
- ✓ All automated analysis + tooling
- ✓ Team interviews (up to 20)
- ✓ Executive + full report
- ✓ Improvement roadmap
- ✓ Founder + team presentations
- ✓ 30-day check-in call

ENTERPRISE

Rs. 15-25L

30-45 days • up to 50+ people

- ✓ Everything in Startup tier
- ✓ Multiple product lines / repos (up to 10)
- ✓ Compliance audit (SOC2/GDPR)
- ✓ Security penetration testing
- ✓ 2 full sprints embedded observation
- ✓ 90-day support (monthly check-ins)
- ✓ Hiring support (JDs + interview design)

Start with a conversation.

50% upfront, 50% on delivery. No lock-in. One-time assessment.
Optional: quarterly reassessment at 40% of original fee.

Talk To Us >>

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